03 / EXAMPLE REPORT

PLANNING FEASIBILITY OUTLINE

A preliminary planning report structure for assessing development options without implying that approval is certain.

01 / FRAMING

Establish what is being tested

Briefly set out the proposal, the site, relevant assumptions, information supplied and the decisions this report is intended to inform.

Part	Purpose
Executive overview	Summarise the question, key issues, preliminary view and next recommended investigations.
Site and records	Describe the property, relevant plans, available title information and gaps in the evidence.
Applicable framework	Identify current zone, overlays, relevant provisions and the consent pathway questions.
Options assessment	Consider practical alternatives or design responses, showing assumptions and key differences.
Constraints register	Document planning, physical, infrastructure and title risks, without overstating certainty.
Specialist inputs	Identify where engineering, surveying, architectural, legal or other technical evidence is needed.
Recommendations	Record the next action, the responsible party and what would resolve each material unknown.

02 / AN EXAMPLE RISK REGISTER

Separate known facts from unverified issues

Issue	Status	Next investigation
Zoning and activity status	To verify	Review current provisions against a defined proposal.
Flood hazard layers	Mapped / unverified	Check layer currency; obtain engineering advice if indicated.
Access and servicing	Unknown	Seek civil or transport design review if appropriate.
Title restrictions	Not checked	Obtain current records and legal interpretation where needed.

03 / DECISION QUALITY

Document uncertainty with care

- State each assumption and the information it relies upon.
- Distinguish planning judgement from engineering, surveying and legal evidence.
- Explain when a new or changed design would require reassessment.
- Do not guarantee consenting outcomes, development yield or approval timeframes.

04 / PROJECT NEXT STEP

A focused instruction is more useful than a vague conclusion

Close the preliminary review with a shortlist of actions: confirm dimensions, engage specialist inputs, refine concept design, obtain council information, or prepare a formal application where appropriate.

IMPORTANT / Official reference: NZ Building Performance — resource consent overview — https://www.building.govt.nz/projects-and-consents/planning-a-successful-build/scope-and-design/check-if-you-need-consents/resource-consent

GENERAL INFORMATION ONLY / This example is not a prepared consent application, certified report, advice on a specific site, or evidence of completed client work. Confirm applicable legislative requirements, current council forms and specialist input before use.